Corrigendum-2 dated 06/08/2026

Request for Proposal (RFP) for Empanelment of Service Providers / Publishers for supply, licensing and access of e-Books for public libraries, Government of Gujarat
RFP# GIL/e-Gov/2026/e-Books
GeM Bid No:- GEM/2026/B/7581031

Please find the Pre-bid queries responses

All bidders are advised to carefully read and consider all Pre-Bid Queries and Responses. Bidders shall take special note of the clarifications provided against Query Nos. 1, 4, 8 and 13 while submitting their bids.

For more details, visit www.gil.gujarat.gov.in & www.gem.gov.in

Pre-Bid Queries Responses of Request for Proposal (RFP) for Empanelment of Service Providers / Publishers for supply, licensing and access of e-Books for public libraries, Government of Gujarat
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#	RFP reference	Content/Clause of RFP requiring Clarification	Clarification Sought/Suggestion	Responses
1	Annexure-1 / Pricing	Price (INR) to be quoted against each title while subscription is multi-user.	Clarify whether quoted price is per title per user, per library, per concurrent user or statewide institutional licence. Also specify expected users/libraries and concurrency.	This bid is for empanelment of service providers/ publishers. The details regarding licence model, user base, libraries, concurrency, and other subscription-related requirements shall be specified at the time of issuance of respective Work Order to successful empanelled bidder(s).
2	Clause 2.3.1 / Pg.20	API / EPUB Access Key requirements.	Please clearly define the technical expectation of 'API access credentials, metadata feed, discovery service integration, ONIX/MARC records, EPUB access keys or equivalent'. Is any one mechanism sufficient or are all mandatory? Please also clarify acceptable API specifications, authentication mechanism, metadata format, DRM expectations and whether secure token/API integration is acceptable instead of sharing EPUB files.	The bidder shall provide one or more industry-standard integration mechanisms, such as API access credentials, metadata feed, discovery service integration, ONIX/MARC records, EPUB access keys, or an equivalent secure mechanism, as applicable to its platform.
3	Clause 2.4 / Pg.21	Own platform and Single Window Platform.	Clarify whether bidder must provide an independent reading platform, integrate with Government Single	Bidder shall provide its own e-book platform and ensure integration with Directorate of Libraries' Single Window

			Window Library Platform, or both because Clause 2.3.1 states Departments' Single Window Library Platform.	Library Platform through the prescribed integration mechanism. Accordingly, both platform availability and integration capability are required.
4	Clause 2.1 / Pg.19-20	70% Gujarati requirement.	Clarify basis of calculating 70% Gujarati content.	The 70% Gujarati content requirement shall be evaluated based on the e-book titles provided by the bidder/publisher in Annexure-1. Accordingly, at least 70% of the proposed titles shall be in the Gujarati language.
5	Clause 2.1 & 2.2 / Pg.19-20	50% competitive content.	Confirm that bidders applying only under Non-Competitive category are not required to maintain 50% competitive examination titles.	As per RFP
6	Pre-Qualification	Turnover from related business activities.	Confirm whether turnover from book publishing (print and digital) qualifies as related business activities.	Already clarified in the corrigendum-1
7	Clause 2.1	Updated/new titles.	Clarify whether prices for newly published titles/revised editions can be quoted separately during empanelment.	The requested details shall be specified, wherever applicable, in the respective Work Order issued to successful empanelled bidder(s).
8	Digital Rights	Withdrawal of titles.	Clarify treatment if publisher loses digital rights during empanelment and replacement mechanism.	This bid is for empanelment of service providers/ publishers. The treatment of such cases, if applicable, shall be governed by the respective Work Order issued to successful empanelled bidder(s).
9	Clause 4.2	Performance Bank Guarantee.	Confirm PBG is applicable only after issuance of Work Order and calculated on Work Order value.	As per RFP
10	Payment	Future Work Orders.	Clarify payment schedule	Payment details shall be

	Terms		for subscriptions under future Work Orders.	specified by the department at the time of issuance of the respective Work Order to the successful empanelled bidder(s).
11	Clause 2.7	SLA uptime.	Specify uptime %, measurement methodology and monitoring.	Minimum 99.5% uptime on a monthly basis, excluding approved maintenance windows. Uptime shall be measured based on system availability logs maintained by Service Provider and verified by Directorate of Libraries.
12	Clause 2.4	Offline reading.	Clarify whether offline reading is mandatory or optional.	Offline reading is optional and may be provided where applicable, as specified under Clause 2.4 of the RFP.
13	Clause 3.5	Future pricing.	Clarify relationship between Annexure-1 rates and future QCBS/LCS selections.	The details provided in Annexure-1 shall be considered for technical evaluation. Work allocation among the successful empanelled bidder(s) shall be carried out as per Clause 3.5 of the RFP.
14	Clause 3.6	Non-response.	Confirm that a formal 'No Bid' response is not treated as non-responsiveness.	Bidders are required to submit a response in all cases. In case a bidder does not intend to participate, the bidder shall submit a 'No Bid' response as per the prescribed process.
15	Clause 7 (NDA)	Reference to USPS.	Clause 7 refers to the United States Postal Service (USPS), which appears to be an inadvertent reference unrelated to this RFP. Kindly confirm and issue a corrigendum if required.	The reference to United States Postal Service (USPS) is an inadvertent template error and has no relevance to this RFP. It may be treated as deleted.
16	Scope of Work / User Base	Number of libraries covered.	Kindly specify the total number of Public Libraries (Central, District, Taluka, Village, etc.) proposed to be	This bid is for empanelment of service providers/ publishers. The number of libraries to be covered shall

			covered under this project during the initial phase as well as the estimated ultimate coverage during the contract period.	be determined by Directorate of Libraries and specified, wherever applicable, in the respective Work Order issued to the successful empanelled bidder(s).
17	Scope of Work / User Base	Expected registered users/readers.	Kindly provide the estimated number of registered users/readers expected to access the e-Book platform so that bidders can appropriately size infrastructure, licensing and commercial pricing.	The expected number of registered users/readers shall be determined by Directorate of Libraries and specified, wherever applicable, in the respective Work Order issued to the successful empanelled bidder(s).
18	Clause 2.3 & Subscriptio n Model	Expected concurrency.	Kindly specify the expected concurrency model (simultaneous users) for e-Book access. Please indicate whether concurrency will be defined per title, per publisher, per library, per district, or across the entire State, along with the expected concurrency numbers for commercial evaluation.	The concurrency model and other subscription-related requirements shall be determined by Directorate of Libraries and specified, wherever applicable, in the respective Work Order issued to the successful empanelled bidder(s).
19	Clause 2.3.1 & Exit Manageme nt	Copyright, DRM & Intellectual Property Protection	Kindly confirm that ownership, copyright and intellectual property rights of all e-Books shall remain exclusively with the Publisher/rightsholder. Please clarify that secure API/DRM-protected access satisfies the requirement, bidders are not required to hand over unencrypted EPUB/PDF/source files, and no permanent copy of the Publisher's digital content shall be stored outside the Publisher's authorised	As per RFP

			platform without written permission.	
20	Clause 2.3 / Subscription Model	Institutional Licence Scope	Kindly define the institutional licence model. Please clarify whether licences are library-wise, district-wise or statewide; whether remote access outside library premises is permitted; whether simultaneous access will be licence-controlled; whether downloading/printing/copying is expected; and whether licence rights extend beyond authorised registered users.	The requirement regarding licence scope, user access, and other applicable terms shall be decided by the Directorate of Libraries and specified, wherever applicable, in the respective Work Order issued to the successful empanelled bidder(s). The access shall be restricted to authorised registered users as per the terms defined by Directorate of Libraries.
21	Scope of Work / Licensing Rights	Third-Party Rights / Author Permissions	Kindly clarify the procedure if a Publisher loses digital distribution rights for any title due to expiry, termination or author/rightsholder instructions during empanelment. Please confirm that such titles may be replaced with equivalent titles and that no penalty shall apply where withdrawal is due to lawful loss of rights beyond the Publisher's control.	In case of withdrawal of any title due to expiry, termination, or loss of digital rights beyond the Publisher's control, the same shall be dealt with as per the terms and conditions specified in the respective Work Order. Replacement of such titles may be considered subject to approval of Directorate of Libraries.
22	General Contract Administration	Contracting Authority	Kindly clarify which authority will issue the final Work Order, execute the agreement, release payments, certify satisfactory performance, administer SLA compliance, and invoke the Performance Bank Guarantee or other contractual remedies: Gujarat Informatics Limited (GIL), the Director of	The Director of Libraries shall be the Contracting Authority and competent authority for all post-empanelment contractual matters.

			Libraries, or both.	
23	Various Clauses referring to "Supply", "Licensing" and "Access" of e-Books	The RFP uses the terms "supply", "licensing" and "access" for e-Books interchangeably. However, it is not clear whether "supply" refers only to providing licensed digital access through the Publisher's platform/API or whether it requires delivery of EPUB/PDF/source files or transfer of digital copies to the Department.	Kindly clarify that "supply of e-Books" under this RFP means providing licensed digital access through the Publisher's authorised platform/API or other approved secure integration mechanism, and does not require transfer of ownership, copyright, or delivery of editable/source digital files (such as EPUB, PDF or other master files) to the Department, unless specifically agreed in writing.	Supply of e-Books under this RFP shall mean providing licensed digital access through the Publisher's authorised platform/API or approved secure mechanism. Transfer of ownership, copyright, or source digital files shall not be required.

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